> rich or poor?
>
> The Mathuras of the country are doubly oppressed, they are women and they belong to an already oppressed section in a nation where justice is the privilege of a few.
>
> [Y]ou don't have to be raped to realize what you're up against. Don't you know it already? Doesn't every woman know it?
>
> Will you be one of the 800 cases reported in Bombay in one year and have the courage to say 'I was raped'? Or will you be one of the 8,000 others, for to every reported rape there are 10–12 unreported ones?[15]

Women's and students' organizations in Delhi, including the National Federation of Indian Women, Stree Sangharsh, the Delhi University Students' Union and the Indraprastha College Women's Committee, combined to form the Joint Action Committee Against Rape and Sexual Harassment. They published a ten-point memorandum seeking 'decisive and immediate' steps in the aftermath of the Mathura case.[16] This included the reopening of the Mathura case, a suspension and departmental inquiry against Tukaram and Ganpat, amending the rape law to exclude evidence concerning a woman's past sexual history, harsher sentences in rape cases and special courts for speedy trials and decisions.

The protests were directed towards two avenues. The first was the Supreme Court, which was asked to reopen the Mathura case. Review petitions filed by several organizations were dismissed on the basis that they lacked the standing to do so as third parties to the case. The court was nevertheless conscious that its decision in the Mathura case damaged its reputation in respect of women's rights. It therefore formulated a 'face saving measure' in a case that arose shortly thereafter.[17] In determining whether corroborating evidence (in addition to the evidence of the victim) was required in cases involving sexual offences, the Supreme Court answered in the negative. This would have been a welcome decision for women's rights groups, had it not been for the court's justification – which reinforced (rather than challenged) the prejudices underpinning the Mathura judgement. The court reasoned its decision on the basis that Indian women were different from women in the 'Western World', and were unlikely to